

Enterprise Prompt Engineering: Taxonomy & Best Practices Guide

1. Fundamentals of Enterprise Prompt Engineering

Prompt engineering is the systematic design, optimization, and evaluation of LLM inputs to maximize accuracy, consistency, and format adherence while minimizing token costs and latency.

2. Core Prompting Techniques Comparison

Technique	Description	Ideal Use Case	Cost / Latency Impact
Zero-Shot Prompting	Direct instruction without examples	Straightforward classification & summarization	Lowest token usage
Few-Shot Prompting	Includes 2-5 high-quality input-output pairs	Structured output (JSON/CSV) extraction	Moderate token increase
Chain-of-Thought (CoT)	Step-by-step reasoning prompts ("Think step by step")	Complex logic, math, multi-stage reasoning	Higher token usage
ReAct (Reason + Act)	Interleaves reasoning with external tool calls	Search, database queries, calculators	Variable latency
System Persona Framing	Defines role, constraints, tone, and forbidden topics	Brand tone consistency and guardrails	Fixed low overhead

3. Best Practice Standards

1. Use explicit XML/Markdown tags (,) to separate instructions from raw data.
2. Specify exact negative constraints (e.g., "Do not extrapolate beyond provided context").
3. Always configure temperature to 0.0 - 0.2 for deterministic business extraction.